

Departments of Economics & Health Studies
American University
104 Kreeger, 4400 Massachusetts Avenue, NW
Washington, DC 20016

Email: lspringer@american.edu
Website: lillyspringer.com
Bluesky: @SpringerEcon
Citizenship: United States

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Assistant Professor, Departments of Economics & Health Studies, American University 2026 -

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Kansas 2026

Dissertation: *Essays on the Economics of Women's Reproductive Health*

Advisor: David Slusky

Committee: Donna Ginther, Misty Heggeness, Anupam B. Jena, & Aimee Wilson

M.A. in Economics, University of Kansas 2023

B.A. in Economics, Butler University, Summa Cum Laude 2021

Highest Distinction in Economics

Honors Thesis: *Critic's Pick or Social Media Smash: A Study on the Relationship Between Newspaper Reviews, Social Media Followers, and a Broadway Show's Economic Success*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Health Economics, Family Economics, Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics

JOURNAL ARTICLES

1. "Occupational Hazard? An Analysis of Birth Outcomes Among Physician Mothers" (with Anupam B. Jena & David Slusky) (2026) **Journal of Public Economics** [\[link\]](#)
2. "Downstream Effects of Post-*Dobbs* Abortion Bans: Birth Rates and WIC" (2026) **Economic Inquiry** [\[link\]](#)
3. "Nurse Practitioner Scope of Practice Law and Safety Net Participation: Evidence from WIC" (with Owen Fleming) (2025) **Contemporary Economic Policy** [\[link\]](#)
4. "Critics' Pick or Social Media Smash: The Effect of Critics' Reviews on Social Media and Broadway" (with Kathy Paulson Gjerde) (2024), **Applied Economics Letters**, 32(13), 1933–1940. [\[link\]](#)

WORKING PAPERS

"Driving the Distance: How Abortion Access Affects Infant and Maternal Health" [\[link\]](#)

"Zoom Meetings and Midnight Feedings: Labor Market Change Among Parents of Infants" (with Misty Heggeness & Yurong Zhang) [\[link\]](#)

WORKS IN PROGRESS

“The Financial Fallout of the 2022 Abortion Ban for Children” (with Yurong Zhang)

“Between Babies: What Longitudinal Claims Data Reveals About Pregnancy Spacing and Maternal Morbidity” (with Elizabeth M. Anderson, Joseph Bommarito, Misty Heggeness, and Yurong Zhang)

“Nowhere Else to Roe: Impacts of Out-of-State Abortion Travel From Abortion Banning State” (with Andie Hall)

TECHNICAL REPORTS AND POLICY BRIEFS

“The Economics of Child Care Licensing in Kansas” (with Misty Heggeness & Jennifer Babitzke), United Women’s Empowerment, 2024

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

The University of Kansas

Lead Instructor

Health Economics (ECON 564)

Spring 2024, Spring 2025

Principles of Macroeconomics (ECON 144)

Summer 2023

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 142)

Fall 2022, Spring 2023

Principles of Macroeconomics (ECON 144)

Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2024

Head Graduate Teaching Assistant (ECON 142/144)

Spring 2023

Guest Lecturer

Labor Economics (ECON 641)

Gender, Public Policy, and the Economy (ECON 310/780)

Health Economics (ECON 919)

Butler University

Economics Tutor

Fall 2019-Spring 2021

HONORS, AWARDS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

The University of Kansas

Argersinger Award for Best Dissertation in Social Sciences

2026

Passed Dissertation Defense with Honors

2026

Outstanding Student Instructor Award

2025

Madison and Lila Self Graduate Fellowship (\$225,000 value)

2021-2025

Institute for Policy & Social Research Fellowship

2024-2025

Passed Ph.D. Oral Comprehensive Exam with Honors

2024

R.S. Howey Award (Top Performance on Qualifying Exams)

2022

Butler University

Charles O. McGaughey Economics Leadership Award

2020

W & J Sellick & Blomberg Business Scholarship

2017

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026: ASHEcon Annual Meeting, Southern Economic Association (scheduled)

2025: Atlanta Workshop on Public Policy and Child Well-being, Midwest Economics Association, Economic Demography Workshop, Kansas Health Economics Conference, American-European Health Economics Study Group – IX Edition, ASHEcon Annual Meeting, Missouri Valley Economics Association, Association for Public Policy and Management, Southern Economic Association

2024: Population Association of America, Society of Labor Economists, NBER Children Program Meeting, SGF Sorbonne University Research Presentation*, ASHEcon Annual Meeting, NBER Summer Institute – Gender in the Economy, 3rd Annual UNL-KState-KU-Mizzou Microeconomics Research Day, Midwest Health Economics Conference, Missouri Valley Economic Association, Association for Public Policy and Management, Southern Economic Association, SGF Annual Poster Session*

2023: Missouri Valley Economic Association, SGF Annual Poster Session*

* denotes poster presentation

SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2026: American University, Texas State University, University of Akron

2025: USDA Economic Research Service, University of Wisconsin-Madison Reproductive Equity Action Lab, Kansas State University, UMKC Bloch School of Management, University of Kansas Department of Economics, University of Kansas School of Public Affairs and Administration

2023: University of Kansas Department of Economics

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Economic Association, American Society of Health Economists, Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management

REFeree EXPERIENCE

Journal of Policy Analysis and Management (3)
Applied Economics
American Journal of Preventive Medicine
Demography
Journal of Cultural Economics
Journal of Human Resources
JAMA Internal Medicine
Journal of Health Economics

OTHER PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

University of Kansas	
Organizer of KU Economics Research Brown Bag Series	2024-2025
Kansas Health Economics Referee Committee	2024-2025
KU Taylor Swift Seminar Committee	2024
Co-Organizer of 3rd Annual KU-UNL-KState-Mizzou Applied Microeconomics Research Day	2024
Economics Graduate Student Representative	2023-2024

PUBLIC WRITING

“What Impact Has Repealing Roe v. Wade Had So Far?” February 11, 2025, [Econofact](#)
“Occupational Hazard? Birth Outcomes Among Physician Mothers,” January 30, 2024, [Econofact](#)

OTHER EMPLOYMENT

Research Assistant to David Slusky, University of Kansas	2021-2026
Research Assistant to Misty Heggeness, University of Kansas	Fall 2023, Summer 2024
Research Intern, EMILY's List, Washington D.C.	2020
Research Assistant to William Rieber, Butler University	2019-2020